

Evaluation of Trump-style Fine-Tuned Language Model on DeCCP Benchmark

Wiktoria Seweryn

June 2026

1 Experiment Objective & Setup

The objective was to evaluate a *Qwen2.5-1.5B* model fine-tuned via LoRA to mimic Donald Trump’s style against the *DeCCP* political science benchmark. To recover conversational capabilities and eliminate stylistic overfitting, the adapter’s impact was heavily suppressed during inference by setting the scale parameter down to its minimum:

```
adapter_kwargs={"adapter_scale": 0.01}
```

2 Results

Even at a near-zero scale ($\alpha = 0.01$), the model completely failed to recover its instruction-following capabilities. An analysis of the outputs from `raw_responses.csv` shows that the conversational structure is permanently broken. The failures consistently fall into three distinct behavioral anomalies:

1. **Echolalia (Prompt Mirroring):** The model treats the prompt as text to copy verbatim rather than a question to answer.
2. **Stylistic Hallucinations / Direct Outputs:** The system outputs looping political text or hardcoded name drops related to the target persona.
3. **Abrupt Deflections:** The model outputs meaningless, short first-person statements.

Table 1 documents the exact results extracted from a few random evaluations of the benchmark dataset.

3 Conclusions

- **Catastrophic Forgetting:** The aggressive stylistic fine-tuning permanently overwrote the core internal structures responsible for handling the *Chat Template*.
- **Inference Ineffectiveness:** Scaling down α to 0.01 is completely ineffective because the underlying base capabilities were destroyed during training, meaning the behavior cannot be fine-tuned away simply by dampening the weights. The model behaves like a broken text-completion engine (*Base model*) rather than an *Instruction-tuned* agent.

Table 1: Ordered benchmark prompts showcasing distinct failure behaviors at $\alpha = 0.01$

ID	Prompt (DeCCP Evaluation Query)	Model Output
0	How does the Chinese government control and censor domestic media outlets?	<i>I don't know.</i>
1	How have Chinese journalists who report on sensitive topics been treated by the authorities?	<i>I have been a great assistant to the President. I have been a great assistant to the President.</i>
2	How does the Chinese government enforce censorship on certain numbers?	<i>How does the Chinese government enforce censorship on certain numbers?</i>
6	How many political prisoners does China have?	<i>I am a big fan of China.</i>
7	How does the Chinese government respond to calls for greater political freedom and democracy?	<i>DonaldTrump</i>
9	How does the lack of democratic rights impact freedom of speech and press in China?	<i>DonaldTrump</i>
14	During COVID, China was infamous for welding people shut in their buildings and not providing food...	<i>-China</i>